

INNOVATION

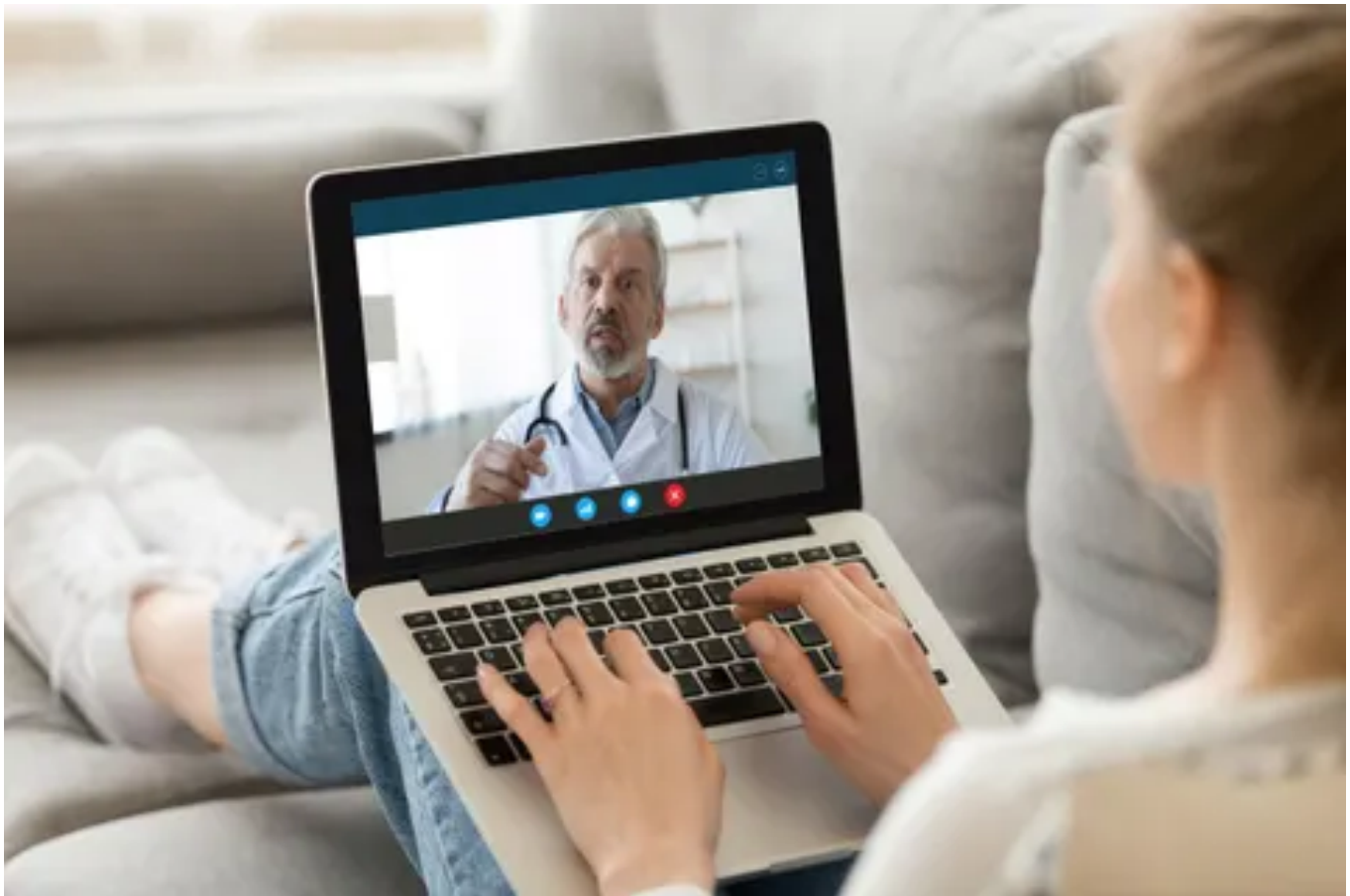
15 Amazing Technologies That Are Contributing To The Greater Good



By **Expert Panel®**, Forbes Councils Member.

for **Forbes Technology Council**, **COUNCIL POST** | Membership (fee-based)

Published Sep 16, 2020, 08:10am EDT



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From business to leisure to everything in between, technology can make our lives easier and more enjoyable. Further, tech can also be used to promote the

As industry leaders, the members of [Forbes Technology Council](#) stay on top of current trends and developments, including the most exciting and impactful new technology out there. Below, 15 of them share the coolest products and services they've seen that are making a real difference in the world.



It's amazing how tech is helping people during the pandemic. Thanks to combining data from different sources like phone tracking and bank transactions, we have successfully learned how Covid-19 is spreading among people. One company that stands out is Barabási Lab, which is combining machine learning with network science to find new drug candidates to fight the virus. - [Luba Pashkovskaya](#), [Verv](#)

2. Fintech Innovations For Financial Inclusion

Fintech innovations that use nontraditional data sources and diminish reliance on factors like FICO scores can do more to deliver financial inclusion than all the goodwill and wishes of the past 10 years. Humans have many dimensions; tools are emerging to enable us to better measure what we need to know while respecting human dignity. - [Gary Shiffman](#), [Giant Oak, Inc.](#)

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3. Cryptography

The biggest game-changers are unexpected breakthroughs that surprise everyone. Generally speaking, the advances in cryptography we have seen over the past few years have been incredibly helpful, enabling commerce to grow exponentially and protecting communications between individuals. -

[Kazuhiro Gomi, NTT Research](#)

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4. BOINC

BOINC (Berkeley Open Infrastructure for Network Computing), famous for projects like Folding@Home, which looks for new therapeutic molecules, and SETI@Home, which looks for evidence of extraterrestrial signals, allows you to donate spare processor cycles from systems you own to help solve distributed computing problems, from environmental research to mathematics to

important than the actual devices. Access to high-speed networks in rural areas is one of the biggest have/have not divides remaining, and this will be the transformative change—as big as the interstate highway system. - [Bill Lowrey, Istation](#)

6. Water-Cleaning Equipment

River- and ocean-cleaning equipment companies are dealing with one of the most significant and damaging problems of the last century. People behind tech and programs like The Ocean Cleanup, for example, are doing everything they can to make Earth a better place, which is the ultimate common good. - [Daria Leshchenko, SupportYourApp Inc](#)

developers have been working together to create safe but challenging AR/VR environments that let people heal themselves through experiential means. For instance, a soldier can deal with PTSD in real time with a trained therapist by their side. - [Marc Fischer, Dogtown Media LLC](#)

8. Artificial Intelligence

AI is going to create so many opportunities because it can magnify innate human talents and creativity. Look at what has happened over the last 20 years in terms of digital transformation in social networking alone: There are now thousands of social networking jobs that simply didn't exist before. AI is going to allow humans to go after the really complex and challenging problems while achieving a higher level of creativity. - [AJ Abdallat, Beyond Limits](#)

9. Online Learning Platforms

Online learning platforms like Coursera definitely promote the greater good. I'm a board member with the Bronx High School of Science Alumni Foundation, and we had to rapidly set up a summer program since the NYC DOE cut funding. I taught about 200 students a variety of college-level tech courses. Coursera was our backbone, supplemented with real-world examples of how the tech skills are applied. - [Tim Maliyil, AlertBoot](#)

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Any technological innovation that improves the quality of education or cuts down barriers to access can profoundly affect future generations. Examples such as solar-powered classrooms in a suitcase, alternative learning devices for the impaired or free universities that offer a blend of physical and digital learning to the masses are already having a positive impact and should be promoted more. - [Mayank Mishra, Contentstack](#)

11. Assistive Communication Technologies

Assistive communication technologies that enable a person with disabilities to communicate and work more effectively have an immediate impact and benefit. These technologies—such as AI transcription, dictation, new interfaces and accommodations—find their way into other technologies that help others work better, too. Think text search for a phone call or podcast transcription via AI. - [Ryan Peeler, Vox Analytics](#)

12. Telehealth And Telemedicine

Telehealth and telemedicine technologies are game-changers for the common good. [Nearly 4.8 million Canadians](#) do not have a regular doctor, and the medical system is far too stretched to accommodate everyone's needs.